

RUBÉN ARTURO RODRÍGUEZ BARRÓN

CONTACT

E-mail: rrodriguezbarron@uchicago.edu

SOFTWARE AND TOOLS

- R
- Python
- Stata
- Qualtrics
- Photoshop
- Lightworks
- After Effects
- Audacity
- Bloomberg Terminal

LANGUAGES

Spanish Native
English TOEFL: 115
French Delf: B2
German TestDaF: A2
Latin Read and Write

RESEARCH INTERESTS

American political behavior; political communication and non-news media; religion and politics; measurement and quantitative methods

EDUCATION

The University of Chicago **Present**

PhD Candidate in Political Science

- Expected Graduation Date: Summer 2027
- Dissertation: *The Political Ecology of American Catholics*
- Certificate in Computational Social Science

The University of Chicago **2023**

MA in Political Science

- Sub-Fields: American Politics and Methodology

The University of Chicago **2019**

Master of Arts Program in the Social Sciences

- Concentration: Political Science
- Thesis: *A Scale to Measure Social and Economic Conservatism*

The University of Texas at Austin, McCombs School of Business **2012**

Master in Professional Accounting

- Track: Financial Reporting and Assurance
- Texas MPA Advanced Excel Certificate

Tec de Monterrey (ITESM), Mexico **2012**

B. A. Finance and Accounting

- Track: International Accounting
- Graduated with Honors

Tec de Monterrey (ITESM), Mexico **2009**

B. A. Financial Management

- Graduated with Honors

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London School of Economics, UK

2008

Summer School

- Business Analysis and Valuation

CONTINUOUS EDUCATION

DataCamp

2019 - Present

Eleven courses in R programming, data visualization, factor analysis, structural equation modeling, and web applications development

Bloomberg University

2016

- Bloomberg Market Concepts: Equity
- Bloomberg Market Concepts: Fixed Income

Harvard University Extension School

2010

- American Constitutional Law
- Introduction to Congress
- Fiction Writing
- Intensive Latin

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Ideology and Priorities in an Organizational Hierarchy: Evidence from US Catholic Bishops

Job market paper. Draft available.

- First quantitative estimate of the ideological position of the U.S. Catholic hierarchy: concentrated rather than polarized, and a bishop's position does not transmit to his priests
- Original pairwise-comparison survey; Bayesian Bradley-Terry model over 1,283 comparisons; 277 bishops; calibration and equivalence testing

From Bloc to Bellwether: The Reversal of the Catholic-Democratic Alignment, 1948-2024

Draft available.

- The Catholic-Democratic alignment has reversed rather than weakened, and what survives is conditional on attendance, ethnicity, and generation
- ANES cumulative file, 1948-2024; roughly forty thousand voters across twenty presidential elections; multilevel models and Oaxaca-Blinder decomposition by decade

Patronage Networks and Ideology in the American Catholic Hierarchy

In preparation.

- Episcopal ties move careers without moving positions: connectivity does not track ideology
- Original relational matrix over the full scored roster; co-consecration, shared formation, and committee service ties; exponential random graph models

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A Scale to Measure Social and Economic Conservatism

Draft available.

- A scale separating social from economic conservatism, showing that the two do not collapse onto a single left-right axis
- Built from existing ANES items; shorter than standard scales and free of the evaluative wording that burdens indirect measures

PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP AND MEDIA

National Catholic Register

March 2026

Quoted in *Is the 'Revival' of Faith in Gen Z Real?* by Jonah McKeown

- Interviewed on the reliability of diocesan conversion data and the delay and estimation error introduced at each step of the reporting chain
- The article's statistical basis is the CARA analysis below

Center for Applied Research in the Apostolate, Georgetown University

January 2026

Are People Flocking to Catholicism in the U.S.? with Mark M. Gray

- Diocesan sacramental data from the Official Catholic Directory, 2013-2024
- Distinguishes post-pandemic catch-up from genuine trend in entries into the Church; normalizes by Catholic population and flags the limits of diocesan population estimates

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago

Spring 2026

Ideological Variation Among U.S. Catholic Bishops: Scores, Networks, and Electoral Implications

New Directions in American History, The University of Chicago

Spring 2026

The Politics of American Catholics

Clergy Health Initiative, Duke University

Fall 2025

Priestly Politics: An analysis of the National Study of Catholic Priests

Research and Analysis in the Sociology of Religion, University of Notre Dame

Fall 2025

The Political Ideology of Catholic Bishops

American Politics Workshop, The University of Chicago

Fall 2019

A Scale to Measure Social and Economic Conservatism

TEACHING & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

The University of Chicago

2018 - Present

Instructor of Record

- Ethics in Action, Chicago Scholars Program (Summer 2026)
- Social Science Inquiry II (2024-25)

RUBÉN ARTURO RODRÍGUEZ BARRÓN

Preceptor

- BA theses, Department of Political Science (2020-21, 2021-22, 2024-25, 2026-27)
- BA theses, Harris School of Public Policy (2020-21, 2026-27)
- MA theses, Master of Arts Program in the Social Sciences (2021-22)

Research Assistant

- Attention, Perception, & Experience Laboratory, Howard C. Nusbaum (2020 - Present)
- Editorial work for *The City in a Garden*, John Mark Hansen (2020)
- Editorial work for *Narrowing the Channel*, Robert Gulotty (2019 - 2020)
- MAP4Parents Program, Michelle Park Michelini (2018 - 2019)

Teaching Assistant

- Computing for the Social Sciences (Nardin, Summer 2026; Soltoff, Summer 2021 and Fall 2019)
- The Intelligible Self (Oliver, Spring 2026)
- Introduction to American Politics (Bloch Rubin, Fall 2025; Hansen, Fall 2019)
- Habits of a Free Mind (Paresky, Spring 2020)
- International Political Economy (Gulotty, Spring 2020)
- Introduction to Machine Learning (Waggoner, Winter 2020)
- Quantitative Security (Poast, Winter 2020)

VALIA, Mexico

2016 - 2023

Professor

- Professional Ethics and Fundamental of Ethics, Business Ethics program

Tec de Monterrey (ITESM), Mexico

2013 - 2016

Associate Professor

- International Accounting, Finance and Accounting program
- Redesigned the course to incorporate ethics case studies

Universidad de Monterrey, Mexico

2014 - 2015

Associate Professor

- Corporate Finance, Accounting and Finance programs
- Redesigned the course to incorporate ethics case studies

PrepaNet, Tec de Monterrey (ITESM), Mexico

2008 - 2012

Instructor

- Social Science Research Methods and Introduction to Computing

Tec de Monterrey (ITESM), Mexico

2007 - 2008

Research Assistant

- Finance Laboratory, Harmen Simons Bijlsma and Luis Humberto Santacruz Medina

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The University of Chicago

2020 - 2025

Academic Technology Specialist

- Produced and managed over 300 hybrid and remote events per academic year
- Coordinated the transition to online teaching for the Division of the Social Sciences during the COVID-19 pandemic
- Assisted pedagogically and technologically in hybrid and remote classrooms
- Established a suite of best practices for divisional student milestone events (e.g., defenses, proposals) and confidential faculty and staff meetings

Website and Publicity Coordinator

2022 - 2023

- Generated content to expand the online presence of the Classics Department

Nicholson Center for British Studies Graduate Intern

2022 - 2023

- Organized events to promote the work of the Nicholson Center for British Studies
- Generated content to expand the online presence of the Nicholson Center for British Studies

CEMEX, Mexico

2016 - 2018

Financial Operations and Corporate Treasury Advisor

- Controlled approximately \$13 billion of corporate debt
- Coordinated global efforts to reduce approximately \$1.5 billion of corporate debt
- Supervised worldwide working capital programs worth approximately \$1 billion
- Evaluated and registered derivative transactions with a notional value of approximately \$80 million

AEGIS Consulting, Mexico

2014 - 2016

Chief Executive Officer and Partner

- Delivered Virtual CFO services to small and family-owned businesses
- Evaluated investment proposals and provided venture capital for start-ups
- Managed sales promotion and public relations for the company and its clients

Grupo DESUS, Mexico

2014

Chief Financial and Administration Officer

- Presented, consolidated, and reported financial information for the eleven firms of the group
- Led the Human Resources department, scouting, recruiting, and servicing over 200 employees

Ernst & Young, Mexico

2012 - 2013

Senior Associate of Advisory Services and Market Development

- Co-designed the national strategy for the firm's business development
- Delivered advisory services to firms in the construction, chemical products, banking, and airline industries

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CBC Edificaciones del Golfo, Mexico

2011 - 2012

Intern

- Elaborated sales proposals, updated internal controls, and conducted risk analysis for construction projects

PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATIONS

American Political Science Association	2025 - Present
Midwest Political Science Association	2025 - Present
Mexican Confederation of Employers (COPARMEX), Treasurer	2007 - 2008
Mexican Institute of Finance Executives (IMEF), Associate	2005 - 2008